

PART

1

PHOTOGRAPHS

This part of the TOEIC® test consists of six black-and-white photographs. You will hear four short statements describing each photograph. The photographs cover typical situations. Most of the photographs are pictures of people. Some photographs are pictures of a scene or an object.

You must choose the statement that best describes what you see in each photograph. The statements are spoken only once, and are not written in your test book.

The statements are short and fairly simple. They are often in the present tense.

There is a short pause between each question, but there are no pauses between the statements you hear that describe each photograph.

QUICK CHECK

How many photographs are in this part of the TOEIC test?

How many statements are there for each photograph?

How many times do you hear each statement?

Are all the photographs of people?

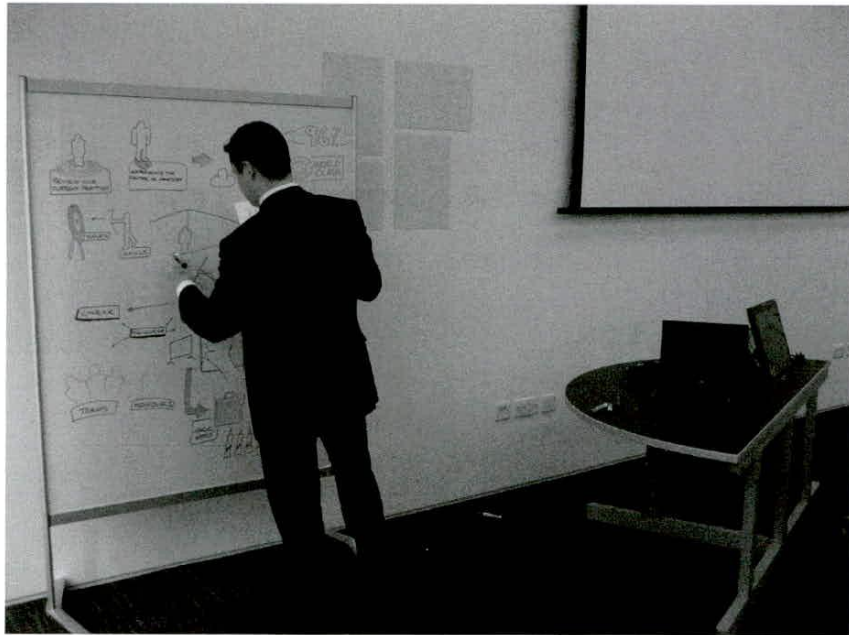
TRY IT OUT

1 Directions

For each question, you will hear four statements about a photograph. Listen and select the one statement: (A), (B), (C), or (D), that best describes the picture. Then mark your answer. You will hear the statements only once.

Look at the photograph and listen to the four statements.

EXAMPLE



[M-Am]

- (A) He's working on a computer.
- (B) He's drawing on the board.
- (C) He's walking into the room.
- (D) He's sitting near the desk.

(A) ● (C) (D)

The best description of the picture is statement (B), "He's drawing on the board." You should mark answer choice (B).

Answer choice (A) incorrectly interprets the situation. The man is not working on a computer. Answer choice (C) uses a word that sounds similar to something you can see in the photograph. He is *working* in the room, not *walking* into the room. Answer choice (D) uses the wrong verb. The man is *standing*, not *sitting*, near the desk.

REMEMBER

On the actual test, you will hear but NOT see the four answer choices.

1.



(A) (B) (C) (D)

2.



(A) (B) (C) (D)

3.



(A) (B) (C) (D)

4.



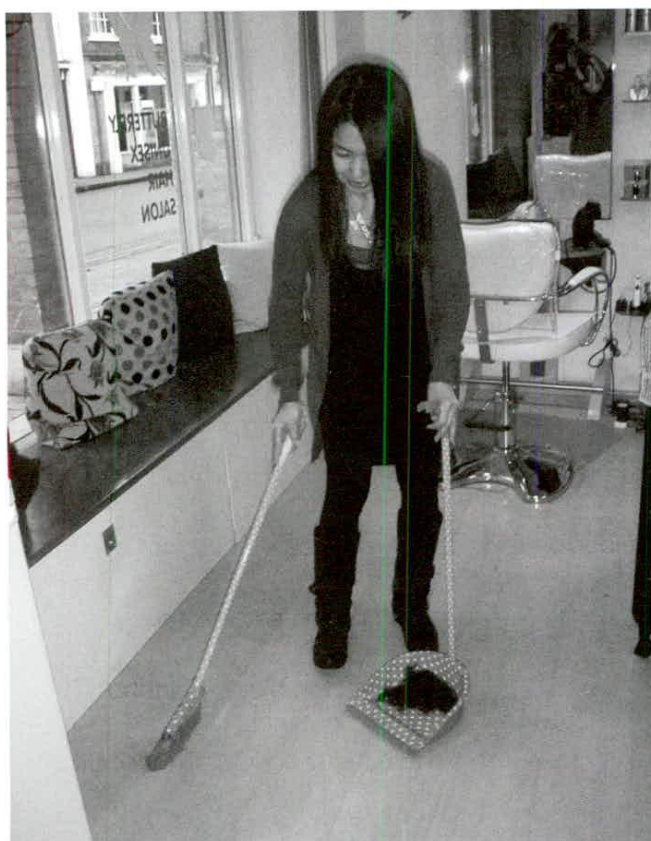
(A) (B) (C) (D)

5.



(A) (B) (C) (D)

6.



(A) (B) (C) (D)

Score/6

IMPROVE YOUR PERFORMANCE

In this section you will practice ways to improve your score on Part 1 of the TOEIC® test.

These are the exercises you will cover:

Analyzing Distractors

understanding why some statements are correct and others are incorrect

Similar-sounding Words

listening carefully to words that sound alike in order to tell them apart

Incorrect Key Words

listening for key words to help identify correct and incorrect statements

Incorrect Interpretations

listening for false accounts; distinguishing between facts and assumptions

As you work through *Improve Your Performance*, look back at your answers in the *Try It Out* section and try to identify your strengths and weaknesses. Notice what problems you have, and focus on the areas you need to improve.

Analyzing Distractors

It is useful to understand why some answers are correct and others are incorrect. In order to do this, you need to identify distractors. A distractor is an incorrect answer choice.

There are many reasons why a statement might be incorrect. However, they can be grouped into three common types of distractor: similar-sounding words, incorrect key words, and incorrect interpretations.

Exercise A

Look at the photograph you saw in Question 1. Read the four statements you heard.

1.



- (A) She's taking something to a customer.
- (B) She's standing at the reception desk.
- (C) She's about to send a fax.
- (D) She's talking on the phone.

The correct answer is answer choice (D), "She's talking on the phone."

This statement correctly describes what is happening in the photograph.

See the chart below for an explanation of each incorrect statement.

Type of Distractor	Incorrect statement	Reason statement is incorrect
Similar-sounding word	(A) She's taking something to a customer.	The word <i>taking</i> sounds like <i>talking</i> .
Incorrect key word	(B) She's standing at the reception desk.	The woman is <i>sitting</i> at the desk, not <i>standing</i> .
Incorrect interpretation	(C) She's about to send a fax.	We cannot be sure that the woman is going to send a fax. There is no evidence.

REMEMBER

On the actual test, you will hear but NOT see the four answer choices.

Exercise B

Now look at the rest of the photographs from the *Try It Out* section. Read the statements you heard. Match each incorrect statement with a type of distractor.

2.



- (A) The women are in an exercise class.
- (B) The instructor is sitting on a stair.
- (C) They're waving at the window.
- (D) The curtains are closed.

..... **A** Correct
 Similar-sounding word
 Incorrect key word
 Incorrect interpretation

3.



- (A) He's examining a card in the garage.
- (B) He's trying to repair the car door.
- (C) He's driving the car into the repair shop.
- (D) He's fixing a tire on the car.

..... **D** Correct
 Similar-sounding word
 Incorrect key word
 Incorrect interpretation

4.



- (A) The tourists are swimming in the lake.
- (B) There's a boat on the water.
- (C) It's a very large snake.
- (D) There are some trees under the water.

 B Correct
 Similar-sounding word
 Incorrect key word
 Incorrect interpretation

5.



- (A) The driver's door is open.
- (B) The trunk is unlocked.
- (C) The man is standing in the truck.
- (D) The man is getting out of the truck.

 A Correct
 Similar-sounding word
 Incorrect key word
 Incorrect interpretation

6.



- (A) She's closing the store.
- (B) She's cleaning the window.
- (C) She's sweeping the floor.
- (D) She's looking at the door.

.....C..... Correct
..... Similar-sounding word
..... Incorrect key word
..... Incorrect interpretation

Similar-sounding Words

Incorrect answer choices sometimes include words that sound similar to key words in the correct answers. For example, a photograph shows a man standing in a hall, but the statement you hear says "He's standing against a wall." The words *hall* and *wall* sound similar. You need to listen carefully to distinguish these similar-sounding words.

Exercise A 2 Listen to the words. Check (✓) the words you hear in each pair below.

- | | | | | | | | |
|----------|-------------------------------------|--------|--------------------------|------------|--------------------------|-------|--------------------------|
| 1. large | ☒ | charge | ☐ | 6. plane | ☐ | frame | ☐ |
| 2. fire | ☐ | hire | ☐ | 7. choose | ☐ | lose | ☐ |
| 3. guest | ☐ | rest | ☐ | 8. close | ☐ | nose | ☐ |
| 4. bag | ☐ | rag | ☐ | 9. sock | ☐ | lock | ☐ |
| 5. wait | ☐ | way | ☐ | 10. waiter | ☐ | water | ☐ |

Exercise B 3 Read these statements. Then listen and check (✓) the statements you hear.

- | | | | |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1. The man is sitting alone. | ☐ | 4. She's setting the table. | ☐ |
| The man is sitting at home. | ☒ | She's sitting at the table. | ☐ |
| 2. He's sailing a boat. | ☐ | 5. There's a bat on the chair. | ☐ |
| He's selling a boat. | ☐ | There's a hat on the chair. | ☐ |
| 3. They're working together. | ☐ | 6. The woman is waiting for a train. | ☐ |
| They're walking together. | ☐ | The woman is waiting for a plane. | ☐ |

Exercise C 4 Look at this photograph. You will hear six statements. Listen carefully and check (✓) *Correct* or *Incorrect* for each statement.

EXAMPLE

You hear: 1. The woman is holding a copy.
This is incorrect. The words *copy* and *coffee* sound similar.

- | | | | |
|------------|--------------------------|-----------|-------------------------------------|
| 1. Correct | ☐ | Incorrect | ☒ |
| 2. Correct | ☐ | Incorrect | ☐ |
| 3. Correct | ☐ | Incorrect | ☐ |
| 4. Correct | ☐ | Incorrect | ☐ |
| 5. Correct | ☐ | Incorrect | ☐ |
| 6. Correct | ☐ | Incorrect | ☐ |



MINI TEST Similar-sounding Words

5 For each photograph, you will hear four statements. Listen and choose the correct statement: (A), (B), (C), or (D). Do not be distracted by words that sound similar to what you see in the photographs.

1.



(A) (B) (C) (D)

2.



(A) (B) (C) (D)

3.



(A) (B) (C) (D)

Score/3

Incorrect Key Words

Some statements describe photographs incorrectly, often by using the wrong key word (verb, noun, adjective, etc.). For example, a photograph shows a man sitting in a bus, but the statement you hear says:

He's **standing** in a bus. (incorrect verb)

He's sitting in a **train**. (incorrect noun)

He's sitting in front of a bus. (incorrect preposition)

Exercise A 6 Look at this photograph. You will hear six statements. Listen carefully to make sure that the key words you hear accurately describe the photograph. Check (✓) *True* or *False* for each statement.

EXAMPLE

You hear: 1. The woman has long dark hair.

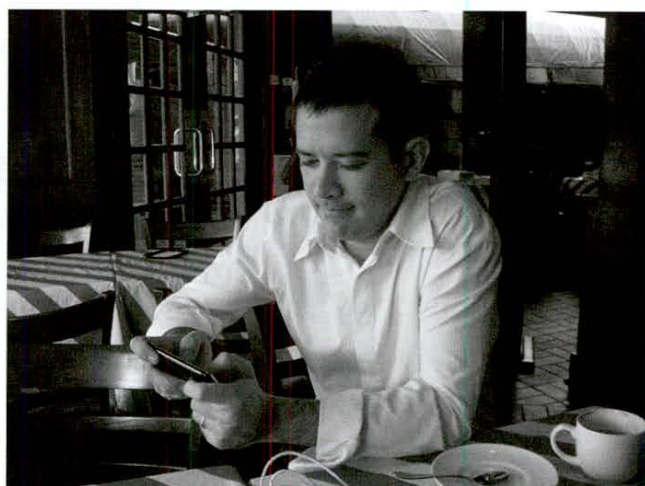
This is **false**. The adjective *long* is incorrect. The woman has *short* dark hair.

- | | | | |
|---------|--------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------|
| 1. True | ☐ | False | ☒ |
| 2. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |
| 3. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |
| 4. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |
| 5. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |
| 6. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |



Exercise B 7 Look at this photograph. You will hear six statements. Listen carefully to make sure that the key words you hear accurately describe the photograph. Check (✓) *True* or *False* for each statement.

- | | | | |
|---------|--------------------------|-------|--------------------------|
| 1. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |
| 2. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |
| 3. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |
| 4. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |
| 5. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |
| 6. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |



MINI TEST Incorrect Key Words

8 For each photograph, you will hear four statements. Listen and choose the statement: (A), (B), (C), or (D), that best describes the photograph. Listen carefully for any incorrect key words.

1.



(A) (B) (C) (D)

2.



(A) (B) (C) (D)

3.



(A) (B) (C) (D)

Score/3

Incorrect Interpretations

Some statements attempt to mislead you by giving a false account of what is happening. For example, a photograph shows two men jogging in a park, but the statement you hear says "They're walking to work." The description does not accurately describe what you see in the photograph.

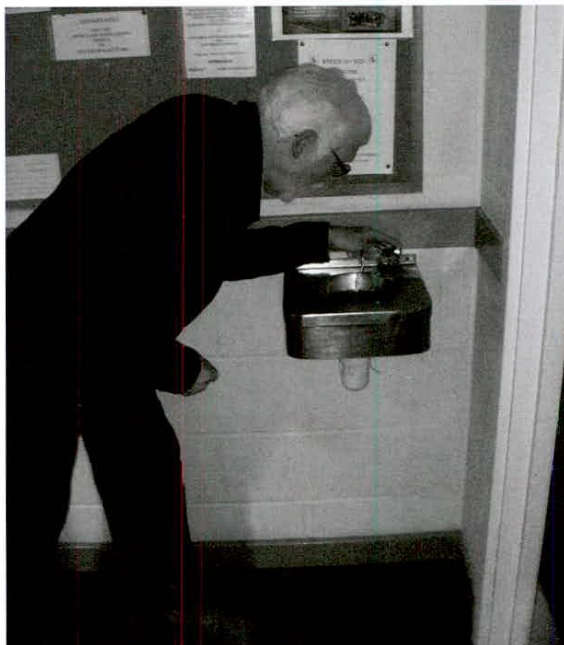
False Accounts 9 Look at this photograph. There are six statements. Listen carefully and check (✓) *True* or *False* for each statement.

EXAMPLE

You hear: 1. He's leaning against the wall.

This is false. He is not leaning against the wall.

- | | | | |
|---------|--------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------|
| 1. True | ☐ | False | ☒ |
| 2. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |
| 3. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |
| 4. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |
| 5. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |
| 6. True | ☐ | False | ☐ |



Some statements also attempt to mislead you by making assumptions that cannot be proven to be true. For example, a photograph shows two women talking outside a restaurant, but the statement you hear says "They're about to have a meal." The assumption is that they will go into the restaurant and have a meal, but there is no visible evidence to support this. (They could, for example, be leaving the restaurant or just passing by.)

Unsupported Assumptions 10 Look at this photograph. There are six statements. Listen carefully and check (✓) *Fact* or *Assumption* for each statement.

EXAMPLE

You hear: 1. They're about to catch a plane.

This is an assumption. There is no evidence to support this.

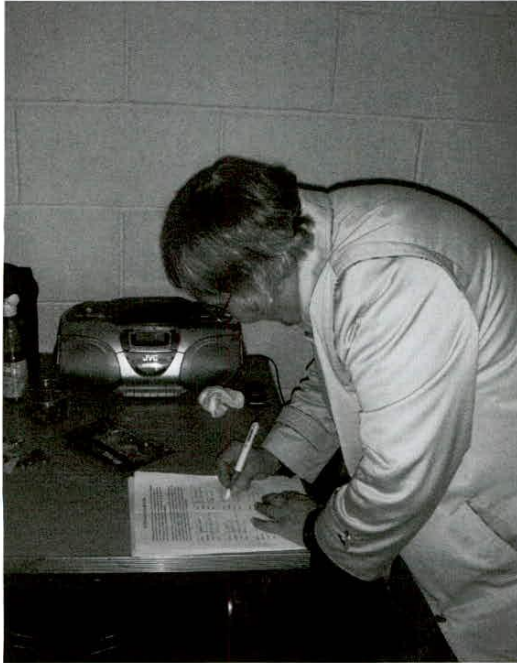
- | | | | |
|---------|--------------------------|------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1. Fact | ☐ | Assumption | ☒ |
| 2. Fact | ☐ | Assumption | ☐ |
| 3. Fact | ☐ | Assumption | ☐ |
| 4. Fact | ☐ | Assumption | ☐ |
| 5. Fact | ☐ | Assumption | ☐ |
| 6. Fact | ☐ | Assumption | ☐ |



MINI TEST Incorrect Interpretations

11 For each photograph, you will hear four statements. Listen and choose the statement: (A), (B), (C), or (D), that best describes the photograph. Do not be misled by false accounts or unsupported assumptions.

1.



(A) (B) (C) (D)

2.



(A) (B) (C) (D)

3.



(A) (B) (C) (D)

Score/3